OCTESSERA

# quick reference

Controls, bindings, behaviors, and Play pages across two pages.

## regular controls

| | |
|---|---|
| *Turn Main* | **Navigate/edit.** Numeric: plain coarse; *Fn* fine; *Shift* and *Shift*+*Fn* stay coarse. Enum, boolean, and text turns stay ordinary. |
| *Click Main* | **Menu selection** / select, edit, confirm |
| *Back* | **Exit location** / exit edit, overlay, or menu level |
| *Play* | **Transport** / play or pause |
| *Shift* + *Play* | **Stop** / external sync arms a one-shot resync |
| *Fn* + *Play* | **Reset stop** / stop, reset position, silence owned notes |
| *Fn* + turn Main right | **Single step** / advance one tick while paused/stopped |
| *Shift* + *Back* | **Clear layer** / re-initialize active layer |
| *Shift* + *Fn* + *Main* | **Context help** / hold modifiers, click menu item |

## navigation + bindings

| | |
|---|---|
| *Fn* + left column | **Navigate to Layer 1-8** / bottom row = layer 1 |
| *Hold Fn* | **Preview** / layers and Play pages |
| *Fn* + right column | **Technical Play pages** / Mix, Pan, Route, Tempo, LFO |
| *Shift* + *Fn* + right column | **Musical Play pages** / FX, XY, Transpose, Rate, Trigger Gate |
| *Shift* + *Fn* + left column | **Gate a layer** / its triggers off, press again to restore |
| *Fn* + *Aux click* | **Bind focused value/action** / value to turn, action to click |
| *Fn* + click *Main* | **Open Aux mapping** / 12-slot scrollable modal |

**Aux map:** stays open after you release *Fn*; turn *Main* to scroll, click *Main* or press *Back* to close.

**Auto-map** fills unbound Aux turns and clicks for this menu area; manual wins unless **Aux Prio.** is **Auto**.

**Aux markers:** row caps show the Aux (1-3 pips, bar: *Shift* bank); footer: turn, click with `!`.

## special grid modes

| | |
|---|---|
| Sample assign | *Shift* + tile maps row; *Shift* + *Fn* + tile maps column |
| Drum assign | *Shift*+tile: row; *Shift*+*Fn*+tile: column; Tile Tune: one tile |
| Probability map | Never, low, high, always. *Shift*+tile: row; *Shift*+*Fn*+tile: column |

## patch orientation

1. Route **sequencer** or **looper** to **sampler** for a rhythm loop.
2. Add **life**, **raindrops**, **bounce**, or **dla** to a **synth**.
3. Use probability on sequencer tiles so patterns feel alive.
4. Bind aux encoders to parameters or actions you keep reaching for.

## behaviors

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| none | Inactive layer | keys | Finger-drumming |
| sequencer | Manual rhythm anchor | looper | Recorded grid gestures |
| life | Birth/survival/death cells | brain | Pulses and trails |
| ant | Walking grid agent | bounce | Moving collisions |
| shapes | Geometric regions | raindrops | Drops and ripples |
| dla | Branching growth | | |

**Triggers:** `activate` tile turns on; `stable` stays on; `deactivate` turns off; `scanned` scanner finds a lit tile; `scanned empty` scanner visits a dark one.

## play pages

| | |
|---|---|
| Mix | Volumes; bottom row mutes (never saved). *Shift*: B1-B4 + master. |
| Pan | Rows are instruments, left to right; bus-routed ones move their bus pan |
| Route | Bottom five rows: direct or B1-B4. Row 6: FX bypass, B1-B4 + Global 1-2. Top row: duck source, saved. Press a bypass again to undo. |
| Tempo | 50-240 BPM ladder, Tap top-left, a -4..+4 nudge row, then Swing A:B (`4:4` straight) |
| LFO | Row per LFO: on/off, then 1/8 to 8 bars (again: triplet). *Shift*: depth. |
| FX | Press mapped tiles to trigger live effects |
| XY | Two-axis surface for mapped parameters. *Shift* + press latches; **Glide** smooths it. |
| Transpose | Synth, FM, Plucked & enabled MIDI; Sampler/Drum when **Follow Transp.** is on |
| Rate | Step rate per layer. *Shift*: Scan Unit. Lit tile: resync at the next bar. |
| Trigger Gate | Per layer: block, custom probability, or allow |

## good to know

**Aux turns:** numbers coarse, *Fn* fine; the *Shift* bank with *Shift* (*Shift*+*Fn* fine). Lists move one option.

**Keyboard** (by key position): grid rows 1-4 from `C F R 4`, left *Alt* 5-8; Aux `123 QWE ASD`.

Factory preset hint: **life** on Layer 1, **sequencer** rhythm on Layer 2.

**Sample browser:** `..` parent, `[folder]` folder, `(empty)` nothing; *Play* previews. Long names clip or scroll.

**Display:** `System > Display > Home Visual` draws the master as scope, spectrum or waterfall on the home page. **Signal** on an instrument, bus or Global FX fills the screen with that sound; click *Main* to flip views. **Main Font** / **Small Font**: Octessera or Original.

**Bench safety:** Power through the enclosure USB-C breakout; remove both the board microSD card and OLED microSD card before closing the case.

> If the grid behaves unexpectedly, check the OLED. You are probably in an overlay or Play page. Use *Back* or *Fn* to leave.

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# tile state to sound

From behavior state and direct input to MIDI, internal audio, routing, and optional live FX.

